Sermon Title: Don’t Quit — God Is Not Finished With You

Main Scripture

> “Let us not grow weary in doing good, for in due season we shall reap, if we faint not.” — *Bible* Galatians 6:9

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1. Opening – When Life Feels Discouraging (5 minutes)

Ask the youth a few questions:

- Have you ever worked hard and nothing seemed to happen?
- Have you ever prayed but the answer did not come quickly?
- Have you ever felt like everyone else was progressing while you were stuck?

Many young people secretly carry discouragement.

They feel:

- left behind
- confused about their future
- tired of trying again

But the Word of God gives us hope.

> “The Lord is close to the brokenhearted and saves those who are crushed in spirit.” — Psalm 34:18

God is not distant from discouraged people.

He is **closest to them**.

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2. Why Young People Become Discouraged (10 minutes)

1. Comparison

Today comparison is everywhere.

Social media shows:

- someone else's success
- someone else's achievement
- someone else's happiness

But comparison destroys confidence.

> “Each one should test their own actions… without comparing themselves to someone else.” — Galatians 6:4

God did not create duplicates.

> “For we are His workmanship.” — Ephesians 2:10

You are **God’s unique creation**.

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2. Failure

Failure can make young people believe:

“I am not capable.”

But failure is not the end.

Scripture reminds us:

> “Though the righteous fall seven times, they rise again.” — Proverbs 24:16

Falling is not the issue.

Refusing to rise again is the issue.

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3. Delays

Sometimes discouragement comes from waiting.

You pray for:

- direction
- success
- opportunity

But the answer delays.

Yet the Bible says:

> “For the vision is yet for an appointed time… though it tarry, wait for it.” — Habakkuk 2:3

God’s timing is never accidental.

STORY 1 – The Story of Joseph: When Everything Went Wrong (10 minutes)

One of the most powerful stories of encouragement in the Bible is the story of Joseph.

Joseph had a dream from God that he would become a great leader.

But after that dream, everything went wrong.

His own brothers became jealous.

They threw him into a pit.

> “They took him and threw him into a pit.” — Genesis 37:24

Then they sold him into slavery.

Later Joseph was falsely accused and thrown into prison.

Imagine being Joseph.

You have a dream from God.

Yet you are sitting in prison.

Most people would assume the dream had died.

But God was still working.

Even in prison.

Scripture says:

> “But the Lord was with Joseph.” — Genesis 39:21

Years later, Joseph walked out of prison and became the **governor of Egypt**, second only to Pharaoh.

And Joseph made this powerful statement:

> “You meant evil against me, but God meant it for good.” — Genesis 50:20

Youth lesson:

Sometimes the worst chapter of your life is **not the end of the story**.

It may be the **beginning of your preparation**.

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3. Three Truths That Destroy Discouragement (15 minutes)

Truth 1: God Sees You Even When Others Overlook You

When Samuel came to anoint the next king, David was not even invited.

He was in the field taking care of sheep.

But God said:

> “Man looks at the outward appearance, but the Lord looks at the heart.” — 1 Samuel 16:7

David went from **shepherd to king**.

Never underestimate what God sees in you.

Truth 2: Your Struggles Are Developing Strength

Difficult seasons produce growth.

Scripture says:

> “Consider it pure joy… whenever you face trials… because the testing of your faith produces perseverance.” — James 1:2–3

And perseverance produces maturity.

> “Let perseverance finish its work so that you may be mature and complete.” — James 1:4

Your struggle may actually be **strength training for your destiny**.

Truth 3: God Finishes What He Starts

Sometimes young people quit too soon.

But God is not a quitter.

> “Being confident of this, that He who began a good work in you will carry it on to completion.” — Philippians 1:6

Your life is not unfinished.

God is still working.

STORY 2 – The Chinese Bamboo Tree (5 minutes)

There is a famous story about the Chinese bamboo tree.

When a farmer plants the bamboo seed, he waters it every day.

Year 1 — nothing appears.

Year 2 — nothing appears.

Year 3 — still nothing.

Year 4 — still nothing above the ground.

Most people would quit.

But in the **fifth year**, something amazing happens.

Within **six weeks**, the tree grows over **80 feet tall**.

Did the tree grow in six weeks?

No.

It was growing **roots for five years**.

Youth lesson:

Sometimes God is working **below the surface**.

Building:

- character
- discipline
- faith
- wisdom

So when your moment comes, you will be strong enough to stand.

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4. Powerful Encouragement for Youth (10 minutes)

Some of you here may feel:

- unnoticed
- uncertain about the future
- afraid of failure

But listen to what God says.

> “For I know the plans I have for you… plans to prosper you and not to harm you.” — Jeremiah 29:11

Your future is not random.

God has a purpose for you.

> “Before I formed you in the womb I knew you.” — Jeremiah 1:5

Your life is intentional.

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5. How to Stay Encouraged (7 minutes)

1. Guard Your Mind

> “Be transformed by the renewing of your mind.” — Romans 12:2

What you feed your mind shapes your future.

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2. Build the Right Friendships

> “Walk with the wise and become wise.” — Proverbs 13:20

Friends influence direction.

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3. Stay Close to God

> “Draw near to God and He will draw near to you.” — James 4:8

Encouragement flows from your relationship with God.

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6. Final Charge to the Youth (5 minutes)

God used young people throughout Scripture.

David was a youth.

Timothy was young when he became a leader.

Paul even told him:

> “Let no one despise your youth.” — 1 Timothy 4:12

Your age does not limit your impact.

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7. Closing Scripture

> “Those who hope in the Lord will renew their strength.
> They will soar on wings like eagles;
> they will run and not grow weary,
> they will walk and not faint.” — Isaiah 40:31

Closing Prayer

“Lord, encourage every young heart here today.
Where there is discouragement, plant hope.
Where there is fear, plant courage.
Remind them that their future is secure in Your hands.
Help them rise and fulfill the purpose You placed in them.
Amen.”
